Lebanese-Style Bruschetta

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

Crisp sourdough, rich tomato tapenade and creamy labneh make a lovely base for juicy cherry tomatoes.

Serves 3–6 · Prep 20 min · Cook 10 min

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE BRUSCHETTA

- 6 slices sourdough bread
- 6 tbsp homemade tomato tapenade, recipe below
- 2 tbsp sun-dried tomato paste
- 250 g labneh
- 250 g cherry tomatoes, quartered
- 3 tbsp basil-infused olive oil, divided
- Sea salt, to taste

FOR THE HOMEMADE TOMATO TAPENADE

- 100 g sun-dried tomatoes in oil, drained
- 50 g pitted black olives
- 4–5 fresh basil leaves
- 1–2 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil, as needed

METHOD

1. Make the tapenade. Place the sun-dried tomatoes, olives and basil in a small food processor. Pulse until finely chopped. Add the olive oil gradually and pulse into a spreadable paste, keeping a little texture.
2. Toast the sourdough. Preheat the oven to 200°C. Arrange the bread on a baking tray and brush lightly with 1 tablespoon of the basil-infused olive oil. Toast for approximately 8–10 minutes, turning halfway through, until golden and crisp at the edges. Allow to cool slightly.
3. Prepare the tomatoes. Toss the quartered cherry tomatoes with 1 tablespoon of the basil-infused olive oil and a little sea salt.
4. Spread the tomato layer. Spread each toast with 1 tablespoon of sundried tomato tapenade
5. Add the labneh. Spoon the labneh generously over the tomato layer and spread gently.
6. Finish with the tomatoes. Divide the cherry tomatoes between the slices. Drizzle with the remaining basil-infused olive oil. Taste before adding any extra sea salt, then serve immediately.

Tip

Follow the layering order. Tomato tapenade first, labneh next, then cherry tomatoes on top.